

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Middle School | Unit 10

Prefixes ad-, ac- & at-



Today I am learning that ad-, ac- and at- are related prefix forms that often carry the idea of to or toward.

1 Learn the Meaning

The Latin prefix *ad-* means to or toward. In many words its spelling changes to match the sound that follows: *ac-* often appears before *c*, and *at-* before *t*. Use the prefix, related words and context together.

adjoin

join to / be next to

adapt

change to fit

accompany

go with

attract

draw toward

2 Build the Word

Use the base/root clue and the correct prefix form. Build the word, then write a short meaning clue.

Base / root	Prefix	New word	Meaning clue
join	ad-		
apt (fit)	ad-		
company	ac-		
claim	ac-		
tract (pull)	at-		

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

At the community design expo, Lila agreed to accompany her brother as he presented a model neighbourhood. Their task was to adapt the display so visitors could move around it easily and attend to the important details. They placed two paths so they would adjoin the central square, then attached clear labels beside each building. A small magnet helped attract metal vehicles toward the station, while a bright arrow directed attention to the emergency route. Before the doors opened, a volunteer asked them to adjust the ramp and attach an extra safety rail. Another staffer accepted the job of checking the map and then accompanied the first group through the display. The moving tram quickly attracted a crowd. Lila explained that *ad-*, *ac-* and *at-* belong to one prefix family. The original prefix often carried the idea of to or toward, but its spelling changed beside certain sounds. The group compared *adjoin*, *accompany*, *attract*, *attach* and *attend*. They also noticed that modern meanings are not always obvious from a simple word sum, so they used related words and context as evidence. By the end of the afternoon, the display had attracted many visitors and the team had accomplished its goal.



Highlight the *ad-*, *ac-* and *at-* words. Circle the prefix form and underline a base/root or related word when you can.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the words by the spelling of the prefix.

adjoin
adapt
adhere
accompany
acclaim
accept
attract
attach
attend
ad-
ac-
at-

6 Use It in Writing



Complete the sentence starters.

a

The prefix family *ad-/ac-/at-* can give me a clue that _____

b

Use one *ad-*, *ac-* or *at-* word in your own sentence. _____



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises the *ad-/ac-/at-* prefix family
- ☐ Explains the to/toward meaning clue
- ☐ Uses a root or related word to investigate meaning
- ☐ Reads and uses target words in context



Capture idea:

Find an *ad-*, *ac-* or *at-* word in a book or information text. Record the prefix form, a related word and what the whole word means.